Padlet in the Classroom: An Open Teacher's Toolkit

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This toolkit gives any teacher six ready-to-run Padlet activities, a setup guide and a safety checklist. It is free to use, adapt and share under a Creative Commons licence.

About this resource

Who it is for: school teachers (Grades 6–12), teacher educators and student teachers who want to use Padlet for more than collecting feedback.

What it grew from: a peer presentation on Padlet in the MA Education and Technology programme at TISS. The activities answer what 11 peers asked for in their feedback: exit tickets, student work examples, other formats and features, uses for teacher trainers, McLuhan's Tetrad and limitations.

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How it meets the renewable assessment criteria

Criterion	How this toolkit meets it
Useful after the class	Teachers can run any activity tomorrow; each one has a prompt, steps, an assessment idea and accessibility notes
Publicly available	Published openly online (see *Reuse, remix and contribute*) so anyone can find it without a login
Openly licensed	CC BY 4.0, so others can adapt it for their subject, grade or language and republish it

Padlet quick start

A Padlet is a shared online board; learners add posts to it and the teacher controls who can post and what appears.

Term	What it means
Padlet (board)	A shared online board where a group posts and organizes ideas
Post	One contribution: text, link, image, video, audio, drawing, file or poll
Format	The board's layout: Wall, Grid, Stream, Columns, Timeline, Map or Canvas
Section / column	A heading that groups related posts, e.g. one column per topic or group
Reactions	Like, vote, star or grade a post
Comments	Threaded replies under a post, used for peer feedback
Moderation	The owner approves posts before they appear

Set up a board in five steps

1. **Create** a board and choose the format that fits the activity (see the activity cards below).
2. **Write the prompt** as the board title and add a pinned post with instructions and an example.
3. **Set permissions:** who can post, whether names show, whether comments and reactions are on, and whether posts need approval.
4. **Share** the link or QR code; test it from a student device first.
5. **Close the loop:** discuss themes in class, then export the board (PDF, image or CSV) as a record.

Padlet's features and free-plan limits change often; check the Padlet Help Centre before planning a large rollout.

Six ready-to-use activities

Each card works in any subject; swap the example prompt for your own topic.

#	Activity	Best for	Format	Time
1	Three-column exit ticket	Formative check at the end of a lesson	Columns	5 min

#	Activity	Best for	Format	Time
2	I see, I think, I wonder	Reflection on an artefact or experiment	Columns	15 min
3	KWL launch board	Prior knowledge before a unit	Columns	10 min
4	Student work gallery	Peer review and improvement	Grid	1–2 lessons
5	Debug wall (Computer Science)	Learning from errors in code	Wall	20 min
6	Share-a-practice wall	Teacher training and PD	Grid or Map	30 min

1. Three-column exit ticket

- **Prompt:** "One thing I learned · One thing I'm unsure about · A question for next class"
- **Steps:** students add one post per column in the last 5 minutes; posts can be anonymous to the class but visible to the teacher.
- **Assessment:** scan the "unsure" column to plan a 5-minute recap; use the Grade reaction or a short comment to acknowledge strong answers.
- **Accessibility:** allow audio posts and sentence starters ("Today I learned that…").

2. I see, I think, I wonder

- **Prompt:** pin a video, image or experiment; students respond in three columns: *I see* (observations), *I think* (explanations), *I wonder* (new questions).
- **Steps:** keep one board per unit and add a column each month so students build a record of learning over time.
- **Assessment:** look for movement from description (*see*) to explanation (*think*); use the *wonder* column to plan inquiry.
- **Accessibility:** audio reflections suit language learners; allow home languages and offer a script to scaffold.

3. KWL launch board

- **Prompt:** "What I **K**now · What I **W**ant to know · What I **L**earned"
- **Steps:** fill K and W at the start of a unit; return to L at the end and connect it to a W post with a comment.
- **Assessment:** compare K and L posts to show growth; W posts reveal misconceptions to address.

- **Accessibility:** let students react (vote) to a peer's post if writing is a barrier.

4. Student work gallery

- **Prompt:** "Post your draft with one line on what you want feedback on."
- **Steps:**
  1. Each student posts work (image, short screen recording or file).
  2. Peers comment on at least two posts using *two stars and a wish*.
  3. Students reply to comments and post an improved version.
  4. The teacher picks examples to discuss in class.
- **Assessment:** grade the improved version and the quality of feedback given.
- **Accessibility:** turn on moderation; agree feedback norms before posting.

5. Debug wall (Computer Science)

- **Prompt:** "Post a screenshot of an error you met this week, what caused it and how you fixed it."
- **Steps:** students post a screenshot plus three lines: *error*, *cause*, *fix*; peers star posts that helped them.
- **Assessment:** check whether the cause is explained, not just the fix; recurring errors become a class mini-lesson.
- **Accessibility:** accept a typed error message where screenshots are hard; a class glossary post defines key terms.

6. Share-a-practice wall (teacher training)

- **Prompt:** "Share one strategy that worked in your classroom this month: what, for whom, and evidence it worked."
- **Steps:** participants post before the workshop; the facilitator groups posts into sections and uses them to open the session. Map format works for teachers across schools or regions.
- **Assessment:** participants comment on one strategy they will try and report back next session.
- **Accessibility:** allow a 1-minute video or audio post instead of writing.

From posting to meaningful collaboration

A board full of posts is not yet learning; five design moves turn posting into collaboration.

1. **Purposeful prompt** — ask for reasoning or evidence, not just an answer.

2. **Build on a peer** — each learner replies to one post and adds a new idea.
3. **Structure the board** — sections or columns keep ideas organized and readable.
4. **Safe space** — agree norms, moderate posts and allow anonymity with care.
5. **Close the loop** — the teacher synthesises themes in class and learners reflect on what changed.

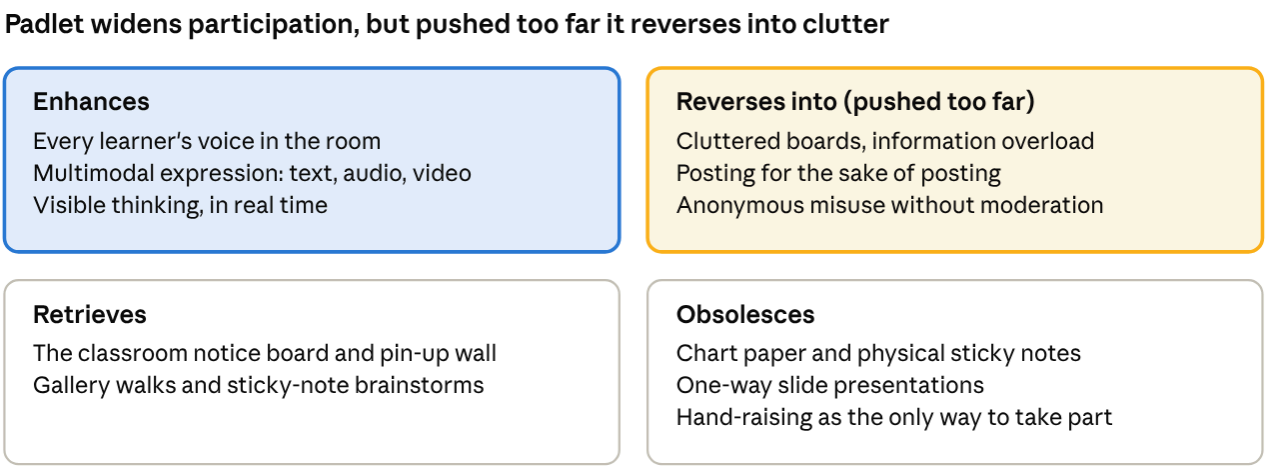
Safety, privacy and accessibility checklist

Run this checklist before sharing any board with students.

- [ ] Board privacy set to *secret* or *password* rather than public
- [ ] Students do not post full names, photos of faces or personal details
- [ ] Use matches your school's data and age policies (and parental consent where needed)
- [ ] Moderation (post approval) and the profanity filter are on for younger classes
- [ ] Class norms for posting and commenting agreed and pinned on the board
- [ ] Anonymous posting decided deliberately, with a plan for misuse
- [ ] Audio, video or typed options offered so every learner can contribute
- [ ] Board kept short or split into sections so screen-reader users can navigate it
- [ ] Low-bandwidth or offline alternative ready (paper slips, then photograph them)
- [ ] Board exported or archived at the end of the unit

Critical lens: McLuhan's Tetrad and limitations

Padlet amplifies participation, but its value depends on the learning design around it, not the tool alone.



Padlet through McLuhan's Tetrad · 4 laws of media

Top row: what Padlet adds (blue) and what overuse turns it into (amber). Bottom row: what it revives and what it replaces.

Limitation	What to do about it
Needs internet, devices and digital readiness	Keep a paper fallback; pair students on shared devices
Free plan limits the number of boards	Reuse boards by clearing or archiving them; check school licences
Large groups create cluttered boards	Use sections, cap posts per student, split into group boards
Posts stay shallow without a clear prompt	Ask for reasoning or evidence; require a reply to a peer
Anonymous posts can be misused	Turn on moderation; anonymity visible to the teacher only
Privacy and age rules vary by school	Check policy and consent before use; no personal details in posts
Hard to judge individual depth of learning	Pair the board with a short individual reflection or conversation
Long walls are hard for screen-reader users	Keep boards short, use Stream or Columns, add alt text to images

Reuse, remix and contribute

Anyone may copy and adapt this toolkit; the only condition is credit to the author under CC BY 4.0.

Where it is published:

- This document, shared publicly as a web link
- A public GitHub repository holding the toolkit as Markdown, so others can suggest changes
- OER Commons, tagged *Padlet*, *formative assessment*, *collaborative learning*, Grades 6–12
- A public Padlet with the six activity boards as templates others can remix

Ways to adapt it: translate the prompts into another language, swap examples for your subject, or add an activity card in the same format (prompt, steps, assessment, accessibility).

To contribute: open an issue or pull request on the GitHub repository, or comment on this document. Contributions are released under the same CC BY 4.0 licence.

References and attribution

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- Padlet and the Padlet Help Centre, for features and settings.
- Creative Commons Attribution 4.0 International.
- Peer feedback from the 2026 ETE presentations, MA Education and Technology, TISS.

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